ascentium

Startup toolkit

Germany

Setting up and running a GmbH in Germany.

Inside: the company at a glance · your first 90 days · the annual compliance calendar · are you an SME? · the documents to gather · how Ascentium helps

Mock toolkit prepared for a concept prototype. Not legal, tax or financial advice.
Information as at November 2026. Verify figures with the relevant authority before relying on them.

1. Your company at a glance

Item	What applies
Entity	Gesellschaft mit beschränkter Haftung (GmbH); the UG is a lower-capital variant
Registry	Commercial register (Handelsregister) at the local court
Share capital	€25,000, of which at least €12,500 paid in before registration
Formation	Articles notarised by a German notary
Tax	About 30% combined: 15% corporate tax plus solidarity surcharge and local trade tax
Transparency register	Beneficial owners must be registered

2. Your first 90 days

Tick these off in order. Your Ascentium dashboard tracks each one and Ascentia will remind you before anything falls due.

- ☐ **Notarise the articles**
  Shareholders sign before a notary (online notarisation is possible).
- ☐ **Pay in the capital**
  Into a company account opened in formation.
- ☐ **Register with the commercial register**
  The notary files the application.
- ☐ **Register the trade**
  Gewerbeanmeldung with the local trade office.
- ☐ **Register with the tax office**
  Submit the tax registration questionnaire to get a tax and VAT number.
- ☐ **Hiring?**
  Register with the employment agency and health insurers.

3. Annual compliance calendar

The recurring obligations most small private companies meet each year. Exact dates depend on your financial year-end and on notices issued by the authorities.

Obligation	When	Authority
VAT pre-returns	Monthly or quarterly, by the 10th	Tax office
Payroll tax returns	Monthly	Tax office
Annual tax returns (corporate, trade, VAT)	By the statutory deadline; extended when prepared by an adviser	Tax office
Annual financial statements	Published within 12 months of year-end	Company register
Shareholders' meeting	To approve the annual accounts	GmbH law

4. Are you an SME?

Germany applies the EU definition for funding: fewer than 250 employees and turnover up to €50 million or a balance sheet up to €43 million. IfM Bonn uses fewer than 500 employees for national statistics.

Ascentium SME pricing

If your company, assessed together with any linked group companies, meets the official SME definition above, you qualify for Ascentium SME fares and the AI platform. Larger groups are served by Ascentium for Enterprise at ascentium.com.

5. Documents to gather

- ☐ **Passport for every shareholder and managing director**
- ☐ **Articles of association**
- ☐ **Registered business address in Germany**
- ☐ **Proof of paid-in capital**
- ☐ **For corporate shareholders: a certified register extract**

6. How Ascentium helps

AI compliance dashboard	A live compliance score for every entity, with each filing, deadline and document in one view.
Ascentia, AI voice assistant	Ask about your status, deadlines or a change, 24/7, and get a qualified expert when judgement is needed.
Premium Economy fare	Formation coordination, tax registration, bookkeeping, annual accounts and tax returns from €5,900 a year, with notary fees at cost.
Switching is easy	Moving from another provider? We take over registers and records and file the change for you.